its aims, the democratic part of the equation will tend to zero. The joke is that after the massive immigration from Russia and the Ukraine, the Jewish dimension of the state is itself getting somewhat slenderer.

At least we enjoy reading about Sara Netanyahu's demands from the Shin Bet to ensure their personal security. The husband is the sad face of the situation, Sara'le is our involuntary comic relief.

Some encouraging pieces of news: today, in heavy rain, some 1,000 officers and soldiers of the reserve (in Israel, reserve duty is compulsory up to one's forties) started a 50 km march from Latrun to Jerusalem. It has been organized by reserve general and former chief of staff Moshe "Bogie" Ya'alon, and includes members of the most prestigious commando units, as well as a ninety-three-year-old veteran of the 1948 Independence War. A major demonstration is planned in Jerusalem, next Monday, in front of the Supreme Court. As we have seen over the last few weeks, many Israelis won't take what is happening lying down.

Thursday, February 9

Deri wanted to push a Shas-sponsored law about the Kotel (the Western Wall): half a year in jail for people coming to the Wall in inappropriate dress or with music. Netanyahu has shelved it, for the time being. Deri has acquiesced. It indicates nonetheless where the coalition is moving. The ayatollahs should be ashamed: they will soon be out-ayatolled. But don't worry too much: a spate of less visible measures are getting through: thus, in forthcoming courses for paramedics, boys and girls will be trained separately.

Today the marchers to Jerusalem are already 2,000-strong.

Finally there was a clash between Ben-Gvir and Yaakov "Kobi" Shabtai, the chief of police. After demonstrations against the reform in Jerusalem, Ben-Gvir went after the head of the Jerusalem police for not having stopped